

NIGHT WORK

FADE IN:

EXT. COASTAL HIGHWAY - NIGHT

Headlights carve the cliff road. MARA VOSS, 30s, drives a 1972 CHEVELLE like she's done it before. A black SEDAN fills her mirror, closing fast.

The sedan clips her bumper. Mara corrects, floors it. The DRIVER, face lost in shadow, pulls level and swings the wheel -- a PIT maneuver.

The Chevelle fishtails. A shot cracks -- MUZZLE FLASH in the sedan's window. Mara ducks, holds the line, pulls away.

INT. ROADSIDE DINER - NIGHT

A bell over the door. Mara slides into a booth across from HOLLIS PRATT, 40s, a fence with a diner-coffee habit. He pushes a manila envelope across the formica.

HOLLIS

You're bleeding on my table.

MARA

Somebody wants this back before I open it.

HOLLIS

Then don't open it here.

She pockets it anyway.

INT. ROADSIDE DINER - DAY

Morning light. Mara reads the case file at the counter.

TESS

PRATT, 11, Hollis's niece, watches from a stool, spinning a coffee cup she isn't supposed to have.

TESS

Is that the car from last night?

MARA

Go do your homework, Tess.

TESS

It's Saturday.

EXT. DINER PARKING LOT - DAY

Hollis stares at the Chevelle, stripped to the frame overnight

-- wheels, seats, wiring, gone. A stray DOG circles the wreck,
sniffing at oil on the asphalt.

HOLLIS

(to no one)

That's a message.

INT. PRECINCT BULLPEN - DAY

CAPT. REYES, 50s, dresses Mara down in front of the whole squad. Detectives pretend not to watch.

REYES

You ran a plate off the books, on
a highway shooting nobody reported.

MARA

Because the sedan that shot at me
doesn't exist. No plate, no VIN.

REYES

Then it's not a case. Go home.

EXT. CLIFF OVERLOOK - COASTAL HIGHWAY - NIGHT

The sedan again, headlights washing the guardrail. Mara's car spins out. She goes over the rail -- catches the ledge one-handed, boots scraping loose gravel toward open air.

The sedan idles above. Doesn't stop. Drives on.

INT. PRECINCT EVIDENCE ROOM - DAY

Tess slips between shelving, small enough to be invisible. She lifts the manila envelope from an evidence bag, tucks it under her jacket, and walks out like she belongs there.

INT. ST. AGNES HOSPITAL - ROOM 4 - DAY

Mara's arm in a sling, road rash along her jaw. Hollis sits by the bed, turning his hat in his hands.

HOLLIS

You went over a cliff for a fence's envelope.

MARA

I went over a cliff because somebody thinks it's worth killing for.

EXT. MARA'S APARTMENT - BALCONY - NIGHT

Mara, arm still slung, watches the street below. The black sedan idles at the corner, engine running, going nowhere.

INT. MARA'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

A corkboard: photos, string, the Chevelle's old registration.

Her phone buzzes -- HOLLIS. She answers on speaker while pinning a new photo to the board.

HOLLIS (V.O.)

The envelope's got shipping manifests.
Harbor warehouses. Somebody's moving
more than cars.

EXT. HARBOR WAREHOUSE DISTRICT - NIGHT

Mara, binoculars, watches from a rooftop across the lot.
Trucks idle outside a corrugated warehouse. Men move crates
under sodium light.

INT. HARBOR WAREHOUSE - NIGHT

Inside: a chop shop. Three cars mid-strip, including a
Chevelle
shell identical to Mara's. DUKE CARABALLO, 50s, watches a
mechanic torch a VIN plate off a fender.

DUKE

Any more of these dumb enough to
still be asking questions?

MECHANIC

Just the cop.

DUKE

Then we're not done.

EXT. HARBOR WAREHOUSE - NIGHT

A dropped bolt clangs off metal -- Mara's cover blown. She

runs
the fence line, vaults a stack of pallets, a guard's
flashlight
sweeping inches behind her.

INT. PRECINCT BULLPEN - DAY

Mara lays photos on Reyes's desk -- the warehouse, the
stripped
Chevelle shell, Duke's face.

MARA

Same crew that ran me off the road.
Same crew that's been feeding you
"nothing to see here" for a month.

REYES

Careful.

INT. PRECINCT - REYES' OFFICE - DAY

Door shut. Reyes lowers his voice.

REYES

You don't know who signs off on
what gets investigated in this
building.

MARA

Say it plainer.

REYES

Drop the warehouse. That's as plain
as I get.

EXT. ST. LOUIS CEMETERY - NIGHT

Mara meets a CONFIDENTIAL INFORMANT among headstones,

collar
up against the cold.

INFORMANT

Duke pays the Captain to lose
paperwork. Has for years. Your
Chevelle wasn't random -- it had
something welded into the frame.

INT. ROADSIDE DINER - NIGHT

Mara and Hollis, heads together over the manifests.

HOLLIS

If Reyes is dirty, Internal Affairs
won't touch this without proof he
can't bury.

MARA

Then we get proof he can't bury.

EXT. DINER PARKING LOT - NIGHT

Tess, supposedly asleep at the counter, slips out back and
climbs into Hollis's truck bed before he notices.

INT. LINCOLN MIDDLE SCHOOL - HALLWAY - DAY

A TRUANT OFFICER stops Tess at her locker.

TRUANT OFFICER

Three absences this month, Ms. Pratt.

TESS

I had a family thing.

TRUANT OFFICER

Every week?

EXT. COASTAL HIGHWAY - DAY

A motorcycle -- RIDER known only as SPINDLE -- runs Mara's car off the shoulder in broad daylight, boxing her toward the guardrail before peeling off at the last second.

INT. PRECINCT GARAGE - DAY

The impounded Chevelle shell up on a lift. A FORENSICS TECH runs a light along the frame rail and finds a cavity welded shut -- cash, and a second set of manifests.

FORENSICS TECH
Somebody built a rolling safe.

EXT. MARINA - NIGHT

Mara meets the informant again, this time on the pier. It's a setup -- Duke's men close from both ends. Gunfire cracks across open water; Mara dives behind a piling.

INT. MARA'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

Mara presses a bandage to a graze along her ribs. Her phone rings -- unknown number, Hollis's ringtone cut short mid-call.

MARA
Hollis?

Silence, then a dial tone.

EXT. HARBOR WAREHOUSE DISTRICT - NIGHT

Mara returns, alone, no backup. Hollis's truck sits

abandoned
at the gate, door open, engine still ticking.

INT. HARBOR WAREHOUSE - NIGHT

Hollis, zip-tied to a chair, a cut above his eye. Duke
circles
him, holding the burner phone Mara gave him weeks ago.

DUKE

Your cop friend's very persistent.
Where's she stashing what she took
from the Chevelle?

HOLLIS

I sell cars. I don't know anything
about safes.

EXT. HARBOR WAREHOUSE - NIGHT

Mara breaches the fence. An ATTACK DOG lunges from the
shadows
between containers; she throws a jacket to buy a second,
clears
a stack of crates, gets to the loading door.

INT. HARBOR WAREHOUSE - NIGHT

Mara cuts Hollis free as Duke's men close in. She holds up
the
burner phone -- already recording -- and plays back Duke
naming
Reyes on tape.

DUKE

That's not admissible.

MARA

It doesn't have to be. It just has
to reach Internal Affairs before
you do.

EXT. HARBOR WAREHOUSE - NIGHT

Headlights -- Reyes's sedan, the same one from the highway.
He steps out, gun drawn, and for the first time says it out
loud.

REYES
This ends here, Voss.

EXT. COASTAL HIGHWAY - NIGHT

The Chevelle -- restored, running -- roars past the
warehouse
gate as Mara floors it toward the cliff road, Reyes's sedan
on her tail one last time. She brakes late into the curve;
he
doesn't.

EXT. CLIFF OVERLOOK - NIGHT

Reyes's sedan goes through the guardrail in a shower of
sparks
and disappears over the edge. Mara stands at the rail,
breathing
hard, watching the taillights fall.

INT. PRECINCT BULLPEN - DAY

Reyes's desk cleared out. Detectives who wouldn't meet
Mara's
eyes a week ago now nod as she passes.

INT. PRECINCT EVIDENCE ROOM - DAY

Tess returns the manila envelope to its shelf, exactly where she found it, and slips out without anyone noticing twice.

INT. ST. AGNES HOSPITAL - ROOM 4 - DAY

Hollis, stitched and bandaged, needling Mara from the bed.

HOLLIS

Next time you need a fence to run
Internal Affairs surveillance for
you, ask nicer.

MARA

Next time, don't get kidnapped.

EXT. ROADSIDE DINER - DAY

Mara, Hollis, and Tess share a booth. No case file on the table for once. Tess steals a fry off Mara's plate.

TESS

So are you actually a detective again, or just the lady who almost died on our highway a bunch of times?

MARA

Working on it.

EXT. COASTAL HIGHWAY - DAY

The Chevelle, whole again, climbs the cliff road in daylight --
clean paint, open road, no one behind her.

FADE OUT.

THE END